Question ID 94b48cbf

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in two variables	

ID: 94b48cbf

The graph of $7x + 2y = -31$ in the xy-plane has an x-intercept at $(a, 0)$ and a y-intercept at $(0, b)$, where a and b are constants. What is the value of $\frac{b}{a}$?

A. $-\frac{7}{2}$

B. $-\frac{2}{7}$

C. $\frac{2}{7}$

D. $\frac{7}{2}$

ID: 94b48cbf Answer

Correct Answer:
D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. The *x*-coordinate a of the *x*-intercept $(a, 0)$ can be found by substituting 0 for y in the given equation, which gives $7x + 2(0) = -31$, or $7x = -31$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 7 yields $x = -\frac{31}{7}$. Therefore, the value of a is $-\frac{31}{7}$. The *y*-coordinate b of the *y*-intercept $(0, b)$ can be found by substituting 0 for x in the given equation, which gives $7(0) + 2y = -31$, or $2y = -31$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 2 yields $y = -\frac{31}{2}$. Therefore, the value of b is $-\frac{31}{2}$. It follows that the value of $\frac{b}{a}$ is $\frac{-\frac{31}{2}}{-\frac{31}{7}}$, which is equivalent to $\left(\frac{31}{2}\right)\left(\frac{7}{31}\right)$, or $\frac{7}{2}$.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Question Difficulty:
Hard